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2023 WORLD CHAMPION

Max Verstappen

Lando Norris

His early life and how he have
started racing in McLaren

RACE CALENDAR

Grand Prix in calendar
in 2023



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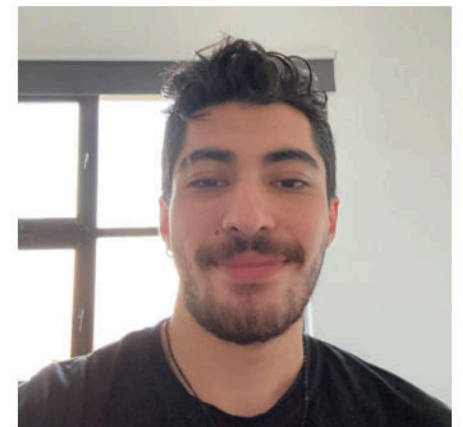
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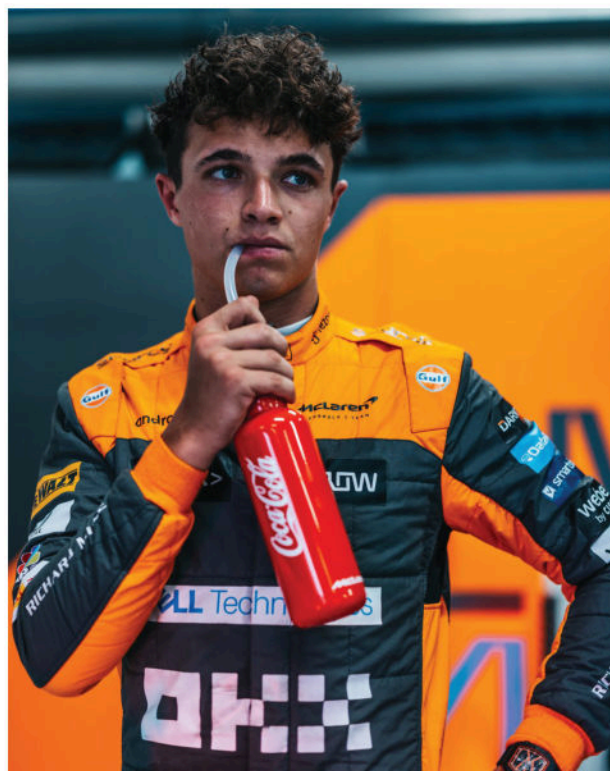
LANDO NORRIS

His early life and how he have started racing in McLaren

Lando Norris may not be named after Star Wars rebel Lando Calrissian - his Mum just liked the moniker - but he has flair and fighting spirit in bountiful supply. McLaren had the British teenager on their books for two years before fast-tracking him into F1's galaxy of stars in 2019. A firecracker in his junior career, with a penchant for pole positions and wheel-to-wheel tussles, Norris didn't let them down. Paired with the highly-rated - and far more experienced - Carlos Sainz, his rookie season was impressive, Norris edging the Spaniard in their head-to-head qualifying battle, scoring points 11 times, and only narrowly missing out on a top-10 championship placing. A maiden podium came in 2020, with more following in

the subsequent two seasons - he narrowly missed out on a win at Russia 2021 - as he dominated another more senior team mate, Daniel Ricciardo, to firmly establish himself in F1's top tier. An exciting talent on track, away from it Norris brims with a modest charm and an artistic side sees him design and paint his own race gear as a hobby. The focus for the future is allying artistry and ambition on track as McLaren rely on the promise of youth to take them back to the top. Norris hopes the downforce will be with him. It speaks volumes that at only 23, Lando Norris became McLaren's senior driver. It was the first time in his career that he had ever been the elder driver in a team, and for many, that would have been a heavy burden, but the British star went on to deliver his strongest season in F1 to date, scoring seven podiums and 205 points.

Possessing natural raw pace, Lando's out-and-out speed has always been evident, but during his five seasons, he's carved out a reputation as a quality qualifier and one of the most consistent racers on the grid. Somewhat shy, but with a playful sense of humour and boyish charm, when he first joined as Test and Simulator Driver in 2017, Lando has grown into a mature and confident leader, with a sharp wit. A gifted karter, Lando remains the youngest driver ever to set a pole position at a national meeting. In 2012, he became Formula Kart Stars champion and runner-up in the MSA Super One British Championship. A year later, he won titles in the CIK-FIA KFJ European, CIK-FIA KFJ Super Cup, WSK Euro Series KFJ, CIK-FIA International Super Cup and World Karting Championship. In addition, he became WSK Masters Series vice-champion.

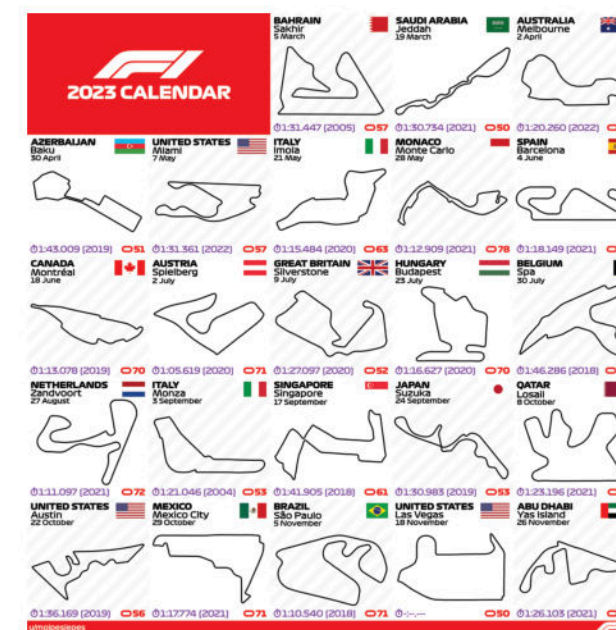


RACE CALENDAR IN 2023

Formula 1 has announced that the Sao Paulo Grand Prix will remain on the F1 calendar until 2030 inclusive following a five-year extension. The Interlagos circuit, officially known as the Autodromo Jose Carlos Pace after the 1975 race winner, has featured on the Formula 1 schedule for over 50 years and is one of the most iconic racetracks in the world. Featuring 15 corners over 4.3kms, the circuit's design originally took inspiration from racetracks in the UK, the United States and France, but has since had parts of the track, including the famous Senna 'esses', replicated at other venues.

Grand Prix in calendar in 2023

With its carnival atmosphere, Interlagos has been the scene for some of the most memorable moments in Formula 1 history including Ayrton Senna's emotional home victory in 1991, Kimi Raikkonen clinching the World Championship in 2007 and Lewis Hamilton's enthralling battle with Max Verstappen in 2021. The 2022 Grand Prix welcomed 235,000 fans across a dramatic race weekend as George Russell won both the F1 Sprint and the Grand Prix, taking the top step of the podium for the first time in his F1 career. Kevin Magnussen also secured a shock first Pole Position of his career for the F1 Sprint, as Interlagos again delivered an entertaining weekend of racing action. The extension of the Sao Paulo Grand Prix follows recent significant investment by Sao Paulo Mayor Nunes' administration, as the city looks to upgrade the Interlagos circuit into a venue suitable for hosting wider entertainment events, including music concerts. In addition, the Grand Prix continues to evolve under the leadership of the promoter MC Brazil Motorsport, backed by Mubadala, who have worked closely with the City of Sao Paulo to enhance the fan experience and have placed an increased focus on environmental social.





2023 World Champion

The Dutch driver took the karting world by storm, winning national, international and world titles. Then, having reached the required age he moved into single-seaters for the 2014 season, contesting the FIA European Formula 3 Championship.

Against more experienced opposition Max won 10 races on his way to third place overall. He had, however, planned his next move long before the conclusion of his debut single-seater season and in August 2014, 16-year-old Max joined the Red Bull Junior Team and was announced as a 2015 race driver for Toro Rosso. After three FP1 appearances in 2014 and a short winter testing

programme, Max made his Grand Prix debut at the 2015 Australian Grand Prix, aged 17 years and 166 days – the youngest driver in the history of the sport. Two weeks after that he grabbed another record, becoming F1's youngest points-scorer with seventh place in Malaysia. A second season with Red Bull's junior squad began in style with three points finishes from his first three races. The talent to challenge for bigger prizes was clear and after that year's the Russian Grand Prix, Max was drafted into the Red Bull Racing line-up. His impact was nothing short of spectacular. On his Team debut at the Spanish Grand Prix he qualified fourth.

MAX VERSTAPPEN

In 2020 he finished third in the Drivers' Championship, taking victories at the 70th Anniversary Grand Prix at Silverstone and the season finale in Abu Dhabi. The victories were supported by remarkable consistency, as he finished on the podium 11 times from the 12 races in which he saw the chequered flag. With momentum building and with the bulk of the 2020 car carried over to the following year, the stage was set for Max to make his first serious bid for championship glory in 2021. Across a hard-fought campaign Max took the fight to a dominant Mercedes team and wins in Imola, Monaco, Paul.



VERSTAPPEN'S FASTESTS LAPS IN 2023

Verstappen and Red Bull crushed the competition by respectively winning 19 and 21 of the season's 22 races, meaning the Dutchman has plenty of standout wins to choose from as he sat down with Motorsport.com to pick his best and worst race weekends of the year. After careful consideration, the triple world champion replied: "I think Spa was still a very strong weekend again. Probably Japan was very strong one – from lap one it was unbelievable to drive. The champions Verstappen faces comparison with on his quest for F1 greatness." "I looked on the screen and I was like, 'alright, that's a good start!' Balance-wise, probably Japan qualifying that was really nice to drive." Verstappen's Suzuka weekend stands out because he was immediately on the pace from the start of free practice and he was a cut above the competition through sector one's famed Esses. Against McLaren's Lando Norris and Oscar Piastri, who posed the biggest threat to Red Bull that weekend, Verstappen immediately took two tenths in Q3 and then continued setting purple sectors to end a whopping six tenths clear of Piastri. In Sunday's race he also went up to half a second quicker than anyone else through the twisty section. Verstappen blitzed the field on Sunday to win by 19 seconds on Norris and 36 on Piastri, with Ferrari and Mercedes over 40 seconds only race Red Bull failed.





Max Verstappen will have to wait until December to get his hands on the Formula One champion's trophy, after winning his third title in Qatar on Saturday, but the Red Bull driver said that was no big deal. Formula One differs from other sports like soccer or tennis in handing out its silverware at a formal awards ceremony rather than at the actual moment of triumph and as part of the immediate show. This year's FIA gala prize-giving is due to take place in Baku on Dec. 8, with the final race of the F1 season in Abu Dhabi on Nov. 26. "It's OK, they look the same. I have two at home so they're not changing," Verstappen told reporters when asked if it

was a shame to have to wait for the trophy rather than be able to raise it aloft with his team mates. "It's just one extra name on it. But it's OK, I can wait a little bit. I've got one next to my sim rig (race car simulator) and one next to the TV." On paper, Sergio Perez was a shoo-in for a slot in our top ten F1 drivers of 2023. He was one of two not named Max Verstappen to win a race and he finished second to the Dutchman in the world championship. And yet, he's not made the cut on ESPN's list, which you can read in full here. It's of course entirely subjective, but the fact this question is even open for debate highlights the kind of year Perez

had. His form was so erratic that much of the narrative around him was whether he would still be driving for Red Bull in 2024. He will be, but that question will be lingering right on the surface next year. Was his season really bad enough to not be considered top ten? As always, these things are about context. There's a key caveat in the list compiled by my colleague Laurence Edmondson earlier this month that the rankings are "based on the car they had at their dispos-

al, the stage they are at in their career and the expectations they faced going into the season," so let's break it down like that.. On paper, Sergio Perez was a shoo-in for a slot in our top ten F1 drivers of 2023. He was one of two not named Max Verstappen to win a race and he finished. Dutchman in the world championship. And yet, he's not made the cut on ESPN's list, which you can read in full here. It's of course entirely subjective, but the fact this question is even open highlights.

